

Skilled-Trades Career and Preparation Evidence

NAME _____ DATE _____ PERIOD _____

Read the Evidence Correctly

These cards compare occupations. They do not promise a specific job, wage, license, program admission, or credential.

CAREER	WORK	TYPICAL PREPARATION	TEXAS BOUNDARY TO VERIFY
Electrician	Installs and maintains electrical power, communication, lighting, and control systems	High school typical; most learn through apprenticeship	License type, hours, and eligibility through TDLR
Plumber, Pipefitter, or Steamfitter	Installs and repairs piping systems	High school typical; most learn through apprenticeship	Apprentice registration and license route through TSBPE
HVAC Mechanic or Installer	Installs, maintains, and repairs heating, cooling, and refrigeration systems	Postsecondary nondegree award typical plus long-term OJT	Technician registration/certification and contractor boundary through TDLR
Welder	Joins or cuts metal parts using occupation-specific processes	High school typical plus technical and OJT routes	Employer/process credentials vary; no single universal Texas welding license

One difference between an occupation, a training route, and a license or credential:

Fixed Labor Evidence

OCCUPATION	MAY 2024 U.S. MEDIAN	GROWTH 2024-34	ANNUAL OPENINGS
Electricians	\$62,350	9%	about 81,000
Plumbers, Pipefitters, and Steamfitters	\$62,970	4%	about 44,000
HVAC Mechanics and Installers	\$59,810	8%	about 40,100
Welders, Cutters, Solderers, and Brazers	\$51,000	2%	about 45,600

Source basis: U.S. Bureau of Labor Statistics, May 2024 national medians and 2024–34 national projections, accessed August 2026. These are not DFW starting salaries or current job-posting counts.

One figure I can use accurately:

One claim these figures do **not** prove:

Four-Career Record

ELECTRICIAN

Work product or decision:

Preparation and state boundary:

PLUMBER, PIPEFITTER, OR STEAMFITTER

Work product or decision:

Preparation and state boundary:

HVAC MECHANIC OR INSTALLER

Work product or decision:

Preparation and state boundary:

WELDER

Work product or decision:

Preparation and credential boundary:

Compare and Verify

Two important preparation differences:

1.

2.

One question I would check with an official state agency or training provider:

The correct official source for that question and why:

One career I would investigate next and the evidence that shaped my choice:
